

DocTurn

Brand & Design Style Guide

Visual & UI System Reference

Document type	Design / brand style guide (grounded in the live codebase)
Version	1.0
Date	June 05, 2026
Source of truth	index.css, tailwind.config.ts, shadcn/ui, manifest.json
Scope	Color, typography, spacing, components, motion, voice, a11y

This guide documents the visual and interface system that gives DocTurn a consistent, calm, and trustworthy feel across the web app, the marketing landing experience, and the mobile app. Every token below is taken directly from the running codebase, so designers and engineers share one source of truth.



Contents

Contents	2
1. Brand Foundations	4
1.1 Brand personality	4
1.2 Two surfaces, one system	4
1.3 The app mark	4
2. Color System	6
2.1 Brand & primary	6
2.2 Semantic UI tokens	6
2.3 Healthcare palette	6
2.4 Status color language	7
2.5 Usage rules	7
3. Typography	8
3.1 Font family	8
3.2 Type scale	8
3.3 Weights & hierarchy	8
3.4 Headings in practice	8
4. Spacing, Radius & Layout	9
4.1 Spacing scale	9
4.2 Corner radius	9
4.3 Elevation	9
5. Iconography & Imagery	10
5.1 Icon system	10
5.2 Imagery & illustration	10
6. Components	11
6.1 Buttons	11

6.2 Badges	11
6.3 Cards	11
6.4 Forms & inputs	11
6.5 Feedback	12
7. Motion & Animation	13
8. Voice & Tone	14
8.1 Principles	14
8.2 Microcopy examples	14
9. Accessibility	15
10. Implementation Reference	16
10.1 Defining a color token	16
10.2 Golden rules	16

1. Brand Foundations

DocTurn (marketed as DoctorHeidi) is a multi-tenant, HIPAA-oriented platform that coordinates patient assignment and secure messaging inside hospitals. The design system has to do two jobs at once: feel reassuring and human on the public marketing surface, and feel fast, dense, and unambiguous inside the clinical product where seconds matter.

1.1 Brand personality

- **Trustworthy** — clinical-grade software handling PHI. Clean surfaces, generous whitespace, no visual noise.
- **Calm under pressure** — used in fast-moving ER and hospitalist workflows. Color is used sparingly and meaningfully, never decoratively in the product UI.
- **Modern & approachable** — the landing experience leans on soft sky gradients and friendly rounded shapes (the Heidi-inspired aesthetic).
- **Precise** — status, urgency, and ownership are always communicated with a consistent, learnable color language.

1.2 Two surfaces, one system

The same color tokens, type scale, and components power both surfaces — only the *density* and the amount of decoration change.

Surface	Feel	Visual treatment
Marketing / landing	Warm, inviting, aspirational	Sky→white→rose gradient backgrounds, large display headings, animated accents, rounded-2xl cards, glow and float motion.
Clinical product	Efficient, legible, low-noise	White backgrounds, compact spacing, semantic status colors, rounded-md controls, motion limited to feedback and loading.
Mobile app	Focused, touch-first	Same tokens, larger touch targets, portrait-first layouts, the blue brand mark on a maskable icon.

1.3 The app mark

The identity is a simple wordmark plus a rounded-square “D” glyph. On the landing page the glyph sits in a sky-gradient tile; as a PWA icon it is a white “D” on the solid brand blue with a 45px corner radius (a maskable icon, so it survives platform masking on Android/iOS).

- Wordmark: **DocTurn**, bold, set in the system sans typeface.
- Glyph: single capital **D**, bold, white, centered.
- PWA brand blue: #2563EB (manifest theme_color and icon fill).
- Clear space: keep at least the height of the “D” glyph clear on all sides.

- Don't: recolor the glyph arbitrarily, stretch the wordmark, or place it on a busy photo without a solid or gradient backing.

2. Color System

Color is defined as HSL CSS variables in `client/src/index.css` and mapped to Tailwind tokens in `tailwind.config.ts`. The product runs in **light mode only** (`color-scheme: light`); there is intentionally no dark theme. Always reference the semantic token (e.g. `bg-primary`), not a raw hex value, so the system stays themeable.

2.1 Brand & primary

Blue is the primary action color across the product. The marketing surface extends it into a lighter “sky” family for gradients and friendly accents.

Aa	Primary	<code>hsl(221 83% 53%)</code>	Primary buttons, links, active state, focus ring
Aa	Brand blue	<code>#2563EB</code>	PWA theme/icon, brand mark, primary CTA on marketing
Aa	Sky 400	<code>#38BDF8</code>	Gradient start, soft accents (landing)
Aa	Sky 500	<code>#0EA5E9</code>	Gradient mid, CTA gradients (landing)
Aa	Sky 700	<code>#0369A1</code>	Gradient end, wordmark gradient (landing)

2.2 Semantic UI tokens

These tokens drive every shadcn/ui component. Foreground pairs are designed for accessible contrast on their matching background.

Aa	background / card	<code>hsl(0 0% 100%)</code>	Page, card and popover surfaces
Aa	foreground	<code>hsl(222 84% 5%)</code>	Primary text on light surfaces
Aa	secondary / muted / accent	<code>hsl(210 40% 96%)</code>	Subtle fills, hover backgrounds, chips
Aa	muted-foreground	<code>hsl(215 16% 47%)</code>	Secondary / helper text, captions
Aa	border / input	<code>hsl(214 32% 91%)</code>	Dividers, control borders, input outlines
Aa	destructive	<code>hsl(0 84% 60%)</code>	Delete actions, error states

2.3 Healthcare palette

A purpose-built clinical palette is exposed as utility classes (`.bg-medical-*`, `.text-medical-*`) for domain semantics that go beyond the base UI tokens.

Aa	medical-primary	hsl(210 100% 50%)	Primary clinical accent
Aa	medical-secondary	hsl(159 100% 35%)	Secondary clinical accent
Aa	medical-accent	hsl(45 100% 51%)	Highlight / attention
Aa	medical-emergency	hsl(0 84% 60%)	Emergencies, critical alerts
Aa	medical-success	hsl(142 76% 36%)	Accepted / confirmed states
Aa	medical-warning	hsl(38 92% 50%)	Pending / needs-attention

2.4 Status color language

Assignment and presence states use a consistent, learnable mapping. Keep these meanings fixed everywhere they appear — cards, badges, dots, stats.

Aa	Pending	amber	Awaiting response, expiring soon
Aa	Accepted / Online	emerald / green	Provider accepted, available
Aa	Active / Sent	blue	In-flight assignment, just sent
Aa	Rejected / Critical	red	Declined, cancelled, error
Aa	Offline / Neutral	slate	Inactive, expired, disabled

2.5 Usage rules

- Lead with neutrals. In the product, the vast majority of any screen is white plus foreground text; color marks only what needs attention.
- One primary action per view — render it with `bg-primary`; everything else is secondary, outline, or ghost.
- Never encode meaning by color alone — always pair status color with an icon and/or label for accessibility.
- Reserve red strictly for destructive or critical states; reserve amber for pending/attention. Don't repurpose them decoratively.
- Gradients belong to the marketing surface, not to dense product screens.

3. Typography

DocTurn uses the platform **system sans-serif stack** (Tailwind's default font - sans) — no custom web font is loaded. This keeps the UI fast, native-feeling on every device, and free of layout shift. The body element sets `font-sans antialiased`.

3.1 Font family

```
font-sans: ui-sans-serif, system-ui, -apple-system,  
  "Segoe UI", Roboto, Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif,  
  "Apple Color Emoji", "Segoe UI Emoji"  
font-mono: ui-monospace, SFMono-Regular, Menlo, monospace
```

3.2 Type scale

Sizes follow the Tailwind scale. Display sizes are used on the landing page; the product UI stays in the `sm–2xl` range for density.

Token	Size	Typical use
<code>text-xs</code>	12px	Badges, captions, dense stats, helper labels
<code>text-sm</code>	14px	Default UI text, buttons, table cells, inputs
<code>text-base</code>	16px	Body copy, paragraph text
<code>text-lg</code>	18px	Card titles, section subheads
<code>text-xl / 2xl</code>	20–24px	Page and panel headings (product)
<code>text-4xl</code>	36px	Secondary marketing headings
<code>text-5xl / 6xl</code>	48–60px	Landing hero headline (responsive)

3.3 Weights & hierarchy

- **font-bold (700)** — headings, hero copy, card titles, numeric emphasis in stats.
- **font-semibold (600)** — badges, sub-labels, emphasized inline text.
- **font-medium (500)** — buttons and interactive labels (the shadcn button default).
- **font-normal (400)** — body and paragraph text.
- Hero headlines use `leading-tight`; body text uses comfortable default leading for readability.

3.4 Headings in practice

- Page heading: `text-2xl font-bold text-foreground`.
- Section heading: `text-lg font-bold`.
- Marketing hero: `text-5xl md:text-6xl font-bold text-slate-900 leading-tight`.
- Body / muted: `text-sm text-muted-foreground` for secondary copy.

4. Spacing, Radius & Layout

4.1 Spacing scale

Spacing uses the Tailwind 4px base scale. Compose padding and gaps from these steps rather than arbitrary values to keep rhythm consistent.

Step	Value	Common use
1 / 1.5	4 / 6px	Icon gaps, tight chip padding
2 / 3	8 / 12px	Button padding, small gaps, badge padding
4	16px	Default card padding, form field gaps
5 / 6	20 / 24px	Card and panel padding
8	32px	Section padding, large CTA padding
12 / 16	48 / 64px	Landing section vertical rhythm

4.2 Corner radius

Radius is driven by a single base token `--radius: 0.5rem (8px)`, with derived steps. Pills (badges, avatars, status dots) use full rounding.

Token	Computed	Use
sm	<code>radius - 4px = 4px</code>	Small inner elements
md	<code>radius - 2px = 6px</code>	Buttons, inputs (default control radius)
lg	<code>radius = 8px</code>	Cards, popovers, dialogs
xl / 2xl	<code>12 / 16px</code>	Marketing cards, hero panels
full	<code>9999px</code>	Badges, avatars, status dots, pills

4.3 Elevation

Shadows stay soft and are used to lift interactive surfaces, not to decorate. Depth increases on hover for clickable cards.

- `shadow-sm` — resting buttons and small cards.
- `shadow-md` / `shadow-lg` — primary CTAs, raised panels.
- `shadow-xl` / `2xl` — marketing hero cards, modals, hover-lifted cards.
- Brand glow: `shadow-sky-500/30` on the primary landing CTA (paired with the pulse-glow animation).

5. Iconography & Imagery

5.1 Icon system

- UI icons come from **lucide-react** — a single, consistent line-icon set.
- Brand / company logos use **react-icons/si** (Simple Icons).
- Default icon size inside buttons is `size-4` (16px); icons are non-interactive and shrink-protected by the button variant styles.
- Match icon color to its context — inherit `currentColor` so icons follow text and status color automatically.
- Use icons to reinforce meaning (status, actions), never as the sole carrier of meaning.

5.2 Imagery & illustration

- Marketing surface favors soft gradient panels and clean product mockups over stock photography.
- Keep imagery light and airy to match the sky/white/rose palette; avoid heavy, dark, or high-noise images.
- Never place PHI (real patient data) in marketing imagery — use realistic but synthetic examples (e.g. initials like “SC”).

6. Components

Components are built on **shadcn/ui** (Radix primitives + Tailwind + class-variance-authority). Prefer these shared variants over bespoke one-off styling so the system stays coherent.

6.1 Buttons

Six variants and four sizes. Base: `rounded-md text-sm font-medium` with a focus-visible ring. One primary (default) button per view.

Variant	Style	When to use
default	bg-primary, white text	The single primary action
destructive	bg-destructive, white text	Delete / irreversible action
outline	border + transparent bg	Secondary action
secondary	bg-secondary (light grey)	Tertiary / supporting action
ghost	transparent, hover fill	Toolbar / inline actions
link	text-primary, underline on hover	Navigational text action

Size	Dimensions	Use
sm	h-9, px-3	Compact toolbars, dense tables
default	h-10, px-4 py-2	Standard buttons
lg	h-11, px-8	Hero / primary CTAs
icon	h-10 w-10	Icon-only buttons

6.2 Badges

Pill-shaped status and category labels: `rounded-full px-2.5 py-0.5 text-xs font-semibold`. Variants: default (brand), secondary (neutral), destructive (critical), outline (low-emphasis). Map badge color to the status language in §2.4.

6.3 Cards

- Product cards: white surface, rounded-lg, border, soft shadow, p-4–p-6 padding.
- Marketing cards: rounded-2xl, gradient or tinted backgrounds, shadow-xl, and hover-lift on interactive cards.
- Group a clear title (bold), supporting content, and at most one primary action per card.

6.4 Forms & inputs

- Inputs use the `input border` token, `rounded-md`, and a focus ring matching `--ring`.
- Build forms with the `shadcn Form` wrapper over `react-hook-form`, validated with the `Zod` insert schemas.

- Always show clear labels and inline validation; error text uses the destructive color.
- `SelectItem` must always have a non-empty value.

6.5 Feedback

- Use the toast system (`useToast`) for transient confirmations and errors.
- Show loading/skeleton states for queries (`isLoading`) and pending mutations (`isPending`) — never leave a blank screen.
- Use the shimmer animation for skeleton placeholders.

7. Motion & Animation

Motion is purposeful: it guides attention, confirms actions, and adds polish on the marketing surface. In the product it is limited to feedback, loading, and subtle state transitions. All custom keyframes live in `index.css`.

Animation	Duration / easing	Purpose
fade-in-up	0.6s ease-out	Entrance for sections/cards (with stagger delays)
bounce-in	0.6s ease-out	Playful entrance for emphasized elements
hover-lift	0.3s ease	Lift + shadow on interactive cards
pulse-glow	2s infinite	Draw attention to the primary CTA
float	6s infinite	Gentle floating accent on marketing
animate-gradient	8s infinite	Slow background gradient shift
shimmer	1.5s infinite	Loading / skeleton placeholders
status-pulse	1.5s infinite	Pulsing presence/status dot
wiggle	0.5s	Icon hover delight
accordion up/down	0.2s ease-out	Expand/collapse panels

Stagger entrance animations with the `.delay-100...600` utilities. Keep motion subtle and brief in the product; honor reduced-motion preferences for users who set them.

8. Voice & Tone

DocTurn talks like a calm, competent colleague. The product is used by busy clinicians, so copy is clear, brief, and free of jargon — favor plain, everyday language.

8.1 Principles

- **Clear over clever** — say exactly what an action does. “Send assignment”, not “Submit”.
- **Brief** — short labels and sentences; clinicians scan, they don't read.
- **Calm & respectful** — no alarmist language; urgency is shown with color and status, not exclamation marks.
- **Action-oriented** — buttons start with a verb (Accept, Decline, Reassign, Message).
- **Privacy-aware** — never expose more PHI than necessary in copy, tooltips, or examples.

8.2 Microcopy examples

Context	Prefer	Avoid
Primary CTA	Get started free	Submit
Assignment sent	Assignment sent to Dr. Chen	Operation successful
Error	Couldn't send — try again	Error 500
Empty state	No pending assignments	Nothing here
Destructive confirm	Delete this conversation?	Are you sure?

9. Accessibility

Accessibility is part of the design system, not an afterthought — this is clinical software used under pressure on varied devices.

- **Visible focus** — a global `:focus-visible` rule draws a 2px primary-color outline with a 2px offset on every focusable element. Never remove it.
- **High-contrast support** — a `prefers-contrast: high` media query darkens borders and inputs for users who need stronger separation.
- **Color is never the only signal** — pair every status color with an icon and/or text label.
- **Contrast** — foreground/background token pairs are chosen for legible contrast; keep text on tinted fills dark enough to read.
- **Touch targets** — interactive controls are at least ~40px tall ($h-10$); give comfortable spacing on mobile.
- **Light scheme** — the app declares `color-scheme: light`; design for light backgrounds only.
- **Semantics** — use real headings, labels, and ARIA from the Radix primitives rather than styling generic elements.

10. Implementation Reference

Where the system lives, so design and code stay in sync.

Concern	Location
Color tokens & medical palette	client/src/index.css (:root CSS variables)
Custom animations & utilities	client/src/index.css (@layer utilities)
Token → Tailwind mapping	tailwind.config.ts (theme.extend.colors / borderRadius)
Component variants	client/src/components/ui/* (shadcn, cva)
Brand / PWA identity	manifest.json (name, theme_color, icons)
Marketing aesthetic	client/src/pages/doctorheidi-landing.tsx
Class composition helper	client/src/lib/utils.ts (cn)

10.1 Defining a color token

```
/* client/src/index.css */
:root {
  --primary: 221.2 83.2% 53.3%;          /* HSL channels, no hsl() */
  --primary-foreground: 210 40% 98%;
  --radius: 0.5rem;
  --medical-success: 142 76% 36%;
}
```

Tailwind then exposes the token as a utility:

```
// tailwind.config.ts
colors: { primary: { DEFAULT: "var(--primary)",
                  foreground: "var(--primary-foreground)" } }

// usage in JSX
<Button className="bg-primary text-primary-foreground">Send</Button>
```

10.2 Golden rules

- Reference semantic tokens, not raw hex, in components.
- Reuse shadcn variants before writing custom component styles.
- Keep red = destructive/critical and amber = pending everywhere.
- Light mode only — don't add dark: variants.
- Pair color with icon/label; preserve focus outlines.